

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Handling conflict!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a conflict with a colleague? What happened?
- What strategy do you use to deal with conflicts?

Can Do Statements

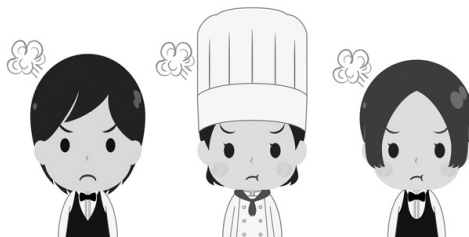
- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.
- I can link an event to another using words like *every time, once, before, and until*.





Let's Explore!

Managing staff is always so hard!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** I called this meeting to talk about what has been going on at the Bistro lately. First, we have an excellent crew here. You provide exceptional service to the customers and are first-rate to work with. That said, I have found that things are getting a little loose around here and I want to get everyone back on point. For example, people need to call me if they can't make it in.
- Michael:** But we were in a car accident. If fender benders didn't happen, we would never be late.
- Vanessa:** I'm glad you guys are OK, but you still have to let me know. Last night, could have been a disaster. If the people here last night had not busted their backsides the restaurant's reputation would have taken a big hit. Every time you forget to phone in, the restaurant's reputation is at stake! Also, we would miss out on big corporate paydays if staff didn't come to work.
- Rachel:** But I was really sick. If I felt better, I'd come to work, but yesterday, I didn't.
- Vanessa:** Sure we have all gotten sick, but before I decide to stay home, I call in and let people know! Give me a call once you've decided. If you called in before your shift began, we would have time to find someone to take your shift. If you guys weren't so late so often we wouldn't be in this mess. That's why you three will be on probation until you've learned to be more conscientious.
- Rachel and Michael:** That's not right!
- Rachel:** That's not fair. I was one of your best employees before any of this happened.
- Vanessa:** Rachel. I know you are hard working, diligent and good at what you do, but you have to call. If you had called me, we wouldn't be having this conversation.
- Rachel:** Vanessa. I'm starting to feel that I am not appreciated around here. So, I quit.
- Alexander and Michael:** So do we.



Let's Practice!

What's wrong with Vanessa's staff?

Instructions: Read the text on page 2 again. Select the correct answers.

1. How does Vanessa describe her staff in a positive way?
 - ☐ They are an excellent crew.
 - ☐ They are second-rate.
 - ☐ They are first-rate.
 - ☐ They provide very poor service.
 - ☐ They provide exceptional service.
2. What are some of Vanessa's concerns about her staff?
 - ☐ Things are getting a little out of point.
 - ☐ Things are getting a little loose.
 - ☐ She wants to get everyone loose.
 - ☐ She wants to get everyone back on point.
 - ☐ People need to call her if they can't make it out.
 - ☐ People need to call her if they can't make it in.



Let's Practice!

Things would be different if ...?

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

If fender benders didn't happen
 If I felt better
 If you had called me
 We would miss out on big corporate paydays
 If you guys weren't late so often

1. _____, we would never be late.
2. _____ if staff didn't come to work.
3. _____, I'd come to work.
4. _____ we wouldn't be in this mess.
5. _____, we wouldn't be having this conversation.



Extension Activity

Talk about conflict resolution!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In a group, brainstorm types of office conflicts.
- With a partner, create a 5 minute role-play of an office conflict situation.
- Role-play your scenario.
- Get classmates to offer suggestions for resolving the conflict.
- Vote on the best one.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm different types of office conflicts.

☐ ☐

I create an office conflict situation.

☐ ☐

I role-play the office conflict.

☐ ☐

I offer feedback on different methods of resolving this conflict.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to get a little loose** (verb): to be more relaxed
e.g. I have found that things are getting a little loose around here.
- **back on point** (expression): to focus on the task at hand
e.g. I want to get everyone back on point.
- **fender bender** (expression): a minor collision between two vehicles
e.g. If fender benders didn't happen, we would never be late.
- **busted their behinds** (expression): to work or be made to work very hard at completing something
e.g. If the people here last night had not busted their behinds the restaurant's reputation would have taken a big hit.
- **payday** (noun): the day you receive your pay from your job
e.g. We would miss out on big corporate paydays if staff didn't come to work.
- **first-rate** (adjective): something that is extremely good
e.g. You are first-rate to work with.





Learning Points

The Unreal Past: Hypothetical but Probable Situation

When you talk about the unreal past, you use past tenses to talk about hypothetical situations and possible results in the present.

You use the **Type 2 Conditional** to refer to a hypothetical situation that could lead to a probable result.

The **Type 2 Conditional** is used to refer to a condition that is in the present. The situation that results from this condition is not certain to be real.

Structure:

If+ subject + Simple Past, subject + Present Conditional

Example:

If I felt better, I'd come to work.

The condition of feeling better is not guaranteed, but it is a possibility.

Examples:

- *If fender benders didn't happen, we **would** never be late.*
- *We **would** miss out on big corporate paydays if staff didn't come to work.*
- *If you called in before your shift began, we **would** have time to find someone to take your shift.*
- *If you guys weren't late so often we **wouldn't** be in this mess.*
- *If you had called me, we **wouldn't** be having this conversation.*





Learning Points

Time Clauses: Every Time, Once, Before, Until

You use **time clauses** to link different clauses and events. Usually a **time clause** introduces a subordinate clause in relation to another event found in the main clause.

You use **every time** to talk about a main action that always happens when the subordinate action happens.

Example:

Every time you forget to phone in, the restaurant's reputation is at stake.

You use **once** when you want to say that something needs to happen for another event to occur.

Example:

Give me a call **once** you've decided.

You use **before** to talk about an action that happens before another action but doesn't necessarily last until the second action begins.

Example:

I was one of your best employees **before** any of this happened.

You use **until** to talk about an action that happens before another action and lasts **until** the second action begins.

Example:

That's why you three will be on probation **until** you've learned this lesson.

Examples:

- We have all gotten sick, but **before** I decide to stay home, I call in and let people know!
- I was one of your best employees **before** any of this happened.

